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ALL ABOARD THE ETIHAD RAIL PASSENGER TRAIN

■ People board an Etihad Rail train at Dubai's Al Yalays Station yesterday, during an exclusive media preview, just a day before passenger services officially launch. Located in Jumeirah Golf Estates, the Al Yalays Station is preparing to welcome passengers travelling between Dubai and Mohamed Bin Zayed Station in Abu Dhabi, with journeys expected to take one hour and four minutes.

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UAE affirms support for Trump's Gaza plan

ISRAEL'S GAZA WITHDRAWAL KEY FOR PEACE, UN TOLD

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

The UAE has called for de-escalation, diplomacy and dialogue to address mounting global divisions and conflicts, setting out a wide-ranging foreign policy agenda focused on peaceful dispute resolution, regional stability, economic development and stronger international cooperation.

Khalifa Shaheen Al Marar, Minister of State, delivering the UAE's statement before the United Nations General Assembly, said the region and the world are going through a period of accelerating change, growing challenges and deepening divisions.

He added that the UAE rejected the unlawful use or threat of force and the resort to coercion, stressing respect for state sovereignty, good-neighbourly relations, international law and the UN Charter.

Effort to end horrific war

On Gaza, Al Marar noted that the UAE had been among the early supporters of the framework established by the international community to end what he described as the horrific war in the enclave.

He stressed the need for full

MOHAMED MEETS NETANYAHU

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan received Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu, who visited the UAE on Sunday.

During the meeting, the two sides discussed bilateral relations between the UAE and Israel and ways to strengthen and further develop them.

—WAM

implementation of US President Donald Trump's Comprehensive Plan to End the Conflict in Gaza and the roadmap stemming from it.

This should include Israel's withdrawal from the Gaza Strip, the disarmament of Hamas and progress towards a serious political horizon leading to a just and lasting settlement of the Palestinian issue based on the two-state solution.

Al Marar also called for the establishment of an independent and sovereign Palestinian state living alongside Israel in peace and security.

He emphasised the importance of unifying Gaza and the West Bank under a capable Palestinian Authority that,

following reform, would be able to carry out its responsibilities and hold exclusive authority over weapons.

West Bank issue

Al Marar also called for an end to the dangerous Israeli escalation in the West Bank, pointing to settlement practices, rising settler violence and terrorism and the isolation of Palestinian villages.

He also highlighted continuing violations in East Jerusalem and at holy sites, along with attempts to impose new historical and legal realities, which the UAE strongly condemned.

The UAE's commitment to the Palestinian people had remained steadfast over decades and continued through its role as the largest donor of humanitarian assistance to Gaza, alongside its humanitarian and development projects in the West Bank.

Al Marar noted that this role stemmed from the enduring values underpinning UAE foreign policy and its commitment to giving, including through effective international partnerships.

He also stressed the principles of international humanitarian law and the protection of civilians.

SEE ALSO P4, 6

Abu Dhabi unveils Dh100b-plus projects

Dh42b lifestyle strategy among major investments in focus at LIVEX 2026

ABU DHABI

BY ABDULLA RASHEED

Abu Dhabi Editor

More than Dh100 billion worth of projects and initiatives are set to feature at the inaugural LIVEX 2026, as Abu Dhabi brings together government, investors and developers to focus on liveability, infrastructure and future city planning.

The three-day Liveability and Investment Exhibition opened yesterday with more than 20,000 participants from 50 countries, including 1,500 investors and over 100 international speakers.

Mohamed Ali Al Shorafa, chairman of the Department of Municipalities and Transport, said Abu Dhabi is working with strategic partners on projects covering residential neighbourhoods, mobility, public spaces, services and facilities.

A major component is the second phase of Abu Dhabi's Lifestyle Strategy, with Dh42 billion allocated for new pro-

jects. The first phase delivered more than 60 projects worth Dh12 billion, while the average level of integration of residential neighbourhoods rose from 67 per cent in 2023 to 81 per cent in 2025.

Spending on infrastructure

Infrastructure spending includes a Dh450 million project to build two bridges linking Al Reem Island with Sheikh Khalifa Bin Zayed Street. The bridges are expected to cut peak-period travel times by up to 60 per cent, saving motorists as much as 15 minutes, with combined capacity of 7,200 vehicles an hour.

Abu Dhabi is also expanding its use of data and artificial intelligence in planning. The Nabd platform combines more than 70 data sources and 15 interconnected systems in a three-dimensional model, while the Fusion Smart Mobility Analysis System has reduced the time needed to analyse traffic studies by up to 40 per cent.

The emirate also has a Dh55 billion portfolio of public-private partnership projects, including Dh35 billion for transport, Dh11 billion for water and environmental infrastructure and Dh9 billion for social infrastructure.

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